ClinicalKey AI

User guide

ClinicalKey AI combines trusted, evidence-based clinical content with conversational search powered by generative AI to support clinicians in delivering high-quality patient care.



Advancing human progress together

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Basics

Access ClinicalKey AI

Visit https://www.clinicalkey.com/ai.

Click the *Help* button **(Fig. 1A)** to discover key information, including:

- Search tips
- Product tour
- Get Started guide
- How it works **(Fig. 1B):**
  - What ClinicalKey AI offers
  - What content sources it uses
  - What functionality is available

Click *Sign In* and enter email address and password.

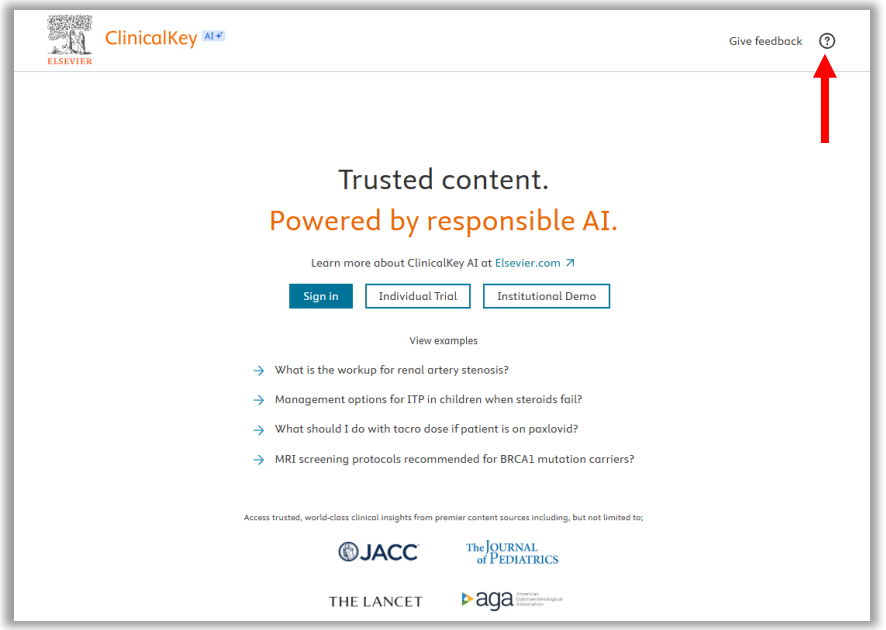


Figure 1A. ClinicalKey AI home page. *Arrow, Help.*

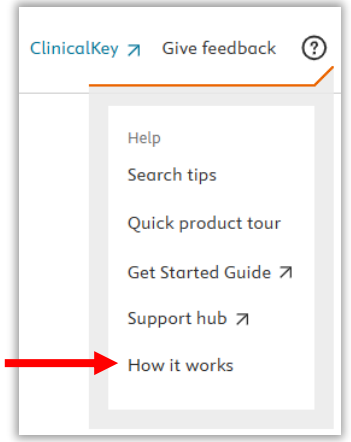


Figure 1B. *Help* menu. *Arrow, How it works.*

Basics

View account

1. Click your account initials and select *View Account* from the menu **(Fig. 2)**.
2. A new window or tab will open to https://myaccount.elsevier.com/. Account options such as language preference, sign in details and account information can be accessed here.

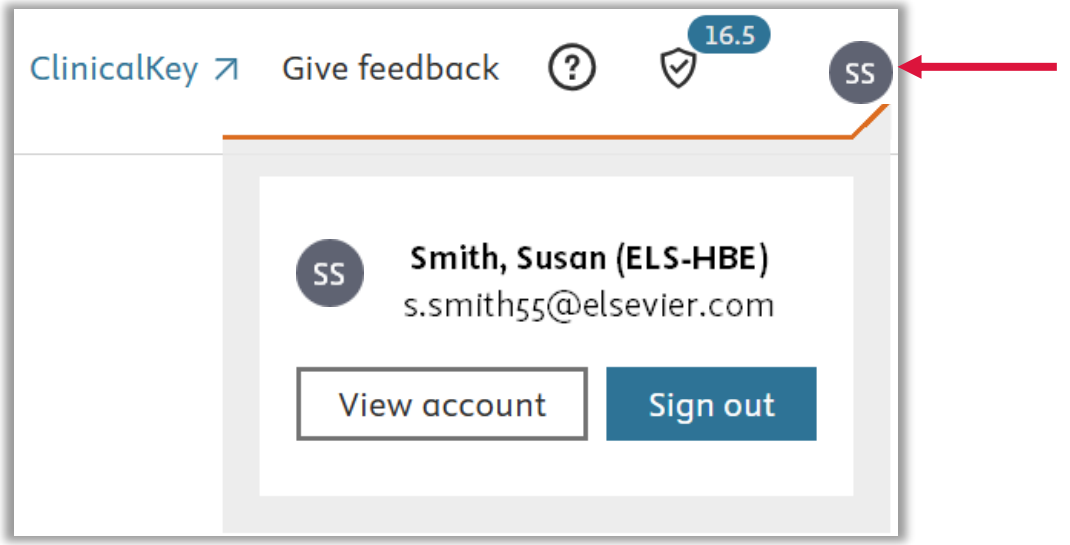


Figure 2. View Account. *Arrow,* account initials.

Basics

Explore sidebar

Collapse or expand the sidebar and ask a new question **(Fig. 3, *A*)**.

Link to ClinicalKey, access the calculators, or access your saved questions **(Fig. 3, *B*)**.

Use your search history to locate and re-execute previous searches (**Fig. 3, *C*)**.

Save, remove, share, or rerun recent questions using the three dots near Recent Questions **(Fig. 3, *D*)**.

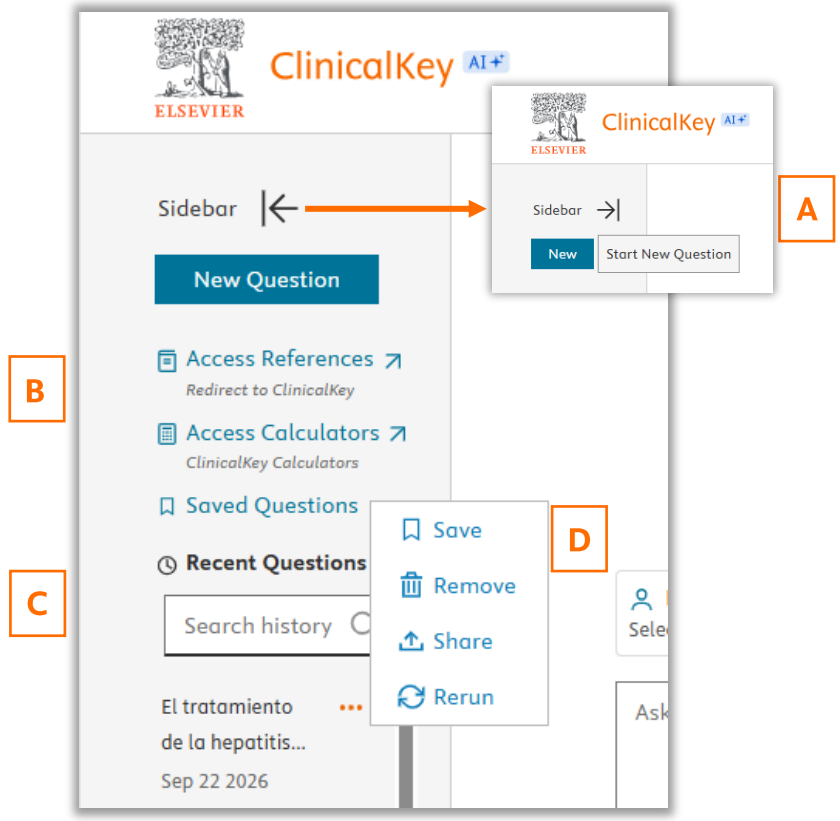


Figure 3. ClinicalKey AI sidebar.

View saved questions / Share feedback

Saved questions

1. Click *Saved Questions* from the left panel of any page.
2. Select the questions you wish to *Remove* or *Unsave* from the list **(Fig. 4, arrow)** using the icons, or choose the three dots next to each question to *Unsave*, *Remove, Share, or Rerun* the question.

Feedback

1. Provide feedback as a thumbs up (helpful) or thumbs down (not helpful) on a specific AI-generated response **(Fig. 5)**.

OR

2. Provide feedback via the *Give Feedback* link in the upper-right corner for generalized product feedback **(Fig. 6)**.

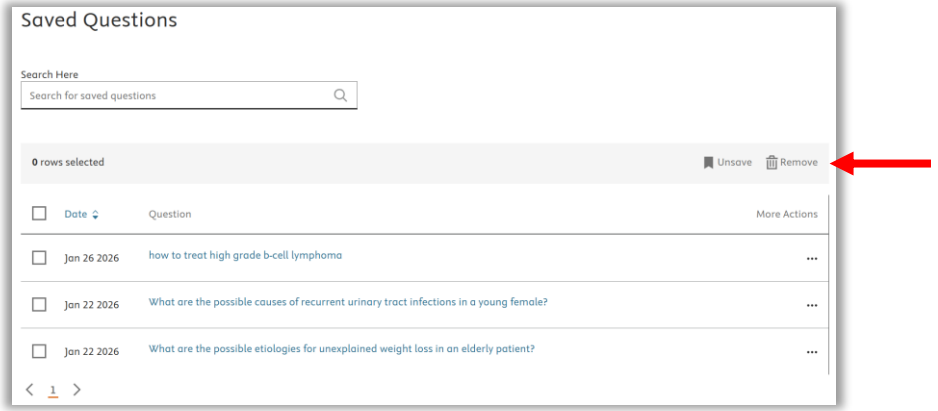


Figure 4. Saved Questions. *Arrow, Unsave* and *Remove* links.



Figure 5. Thumbs-up (helpful) and Thumbs-down (not helpful) feedback options on responses *(arrow)*.

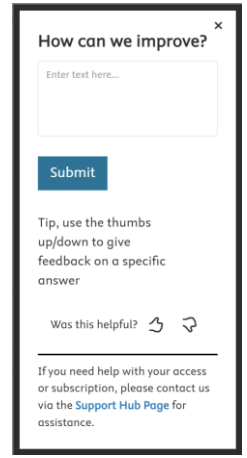


Figure 6. Give feedback.

Point-of-Care mode

Ask point-of-care question

Choose ***Point-of-care*** mode for fast, evidence-based clinical decision making **(Fig. 7, *A*)**. (In contrast, *Deep Research* mode is for in-depth reports and analysis.)

Search tips are accessible above the text field **(Fig. 7, *B*)**.

Select your population focus with the dropdown menu **(Fig. 7, *C*)**.

- *All Ages* (default)
- *Pediatrics,* or
- *Adults*

The toggle retains your chosen state until you modify it in the future.

From the home page, enter your clinical question into the text field using natural language **(Fig. 7, *D*)**.

Instructions below the search field warn that you should not include protected health information (PHI) nor should you use ClinicalKey AI as a calculator, as a staging tool, or for IV compatibility **(Fig. 7, *E*)**.

Query assistance is available through prompt examples **(Fig. 7, *F*)**.

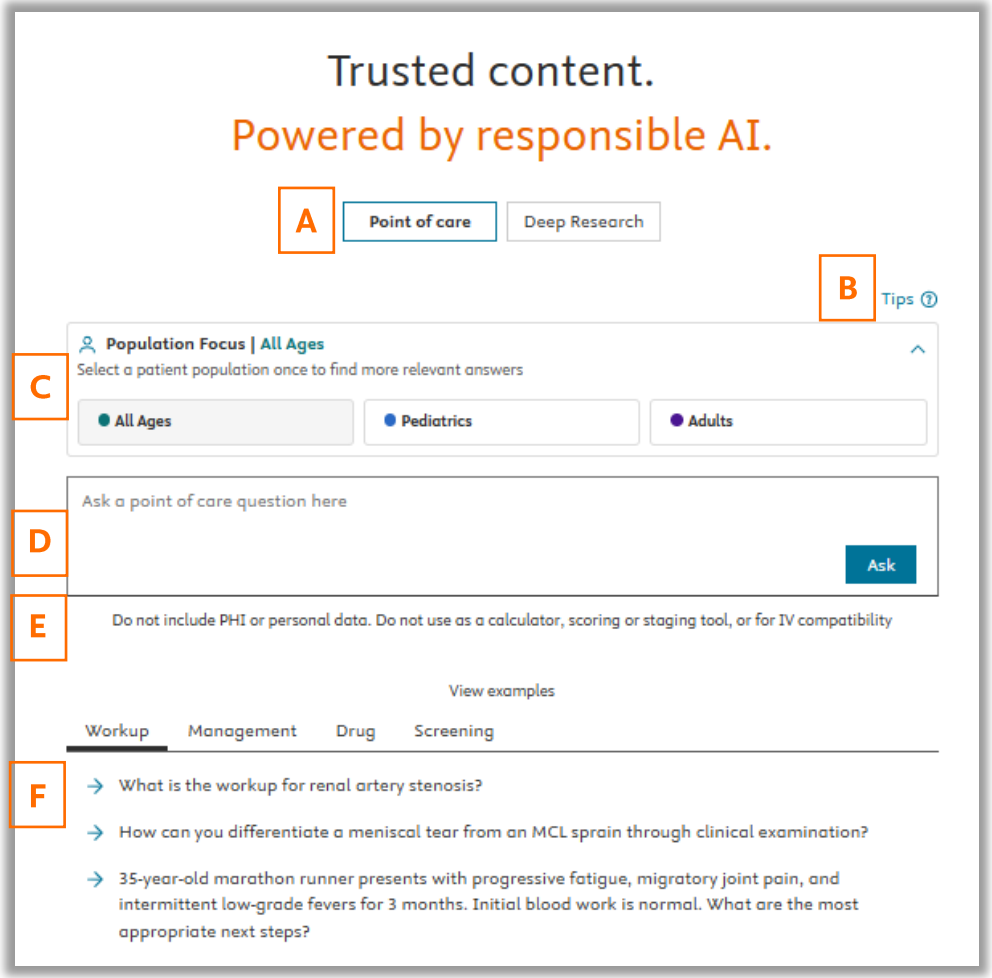


Figure 7. ClinicalKey AI home page. *A, Point-of-Care* and *Deep Research* modes; *B, Tips; C,* Patient *Population Focus; D, Ask* field; *E,* instructions; *F,* View examples.

Point-of-Care mode

Review response

ClinicalKey AI will re-write the query with applied spelling checks and expand any acronyms before the response is generated on-screen.

1. Review the summary and bulleted statements for AI-generated response **(Fig. 8, *A*)**.
2. Choose to *Save* for future use or *Share** the query with a colleague **(Fig. 8, *B*)**.

   * If sharing is configured for your institution, see additional details here.
3. Expand *Additional Information* drop-down for further details (**Fig. 9, *A*)**.
4. Consult *References* for evidence-based sourcing and publication details **(Fig. 9, *B*)**.
5. Redeem your earned CME credits by clicking *CME* **(Fig. 9, C)**.

If ClinicalKey AI cannot generate a response, based upon current literature sources, users will encounter an Insufficient Evidence message.

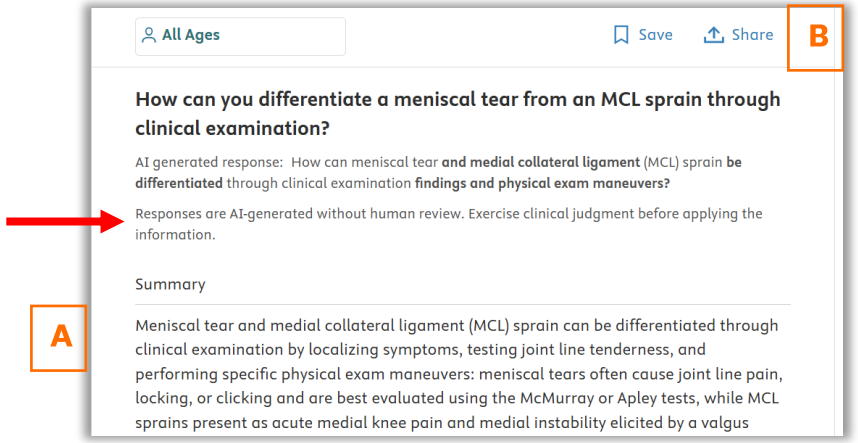


Figure 8. ClinicalKey AI response. *Arrow,* AI-generated response disclaimer.

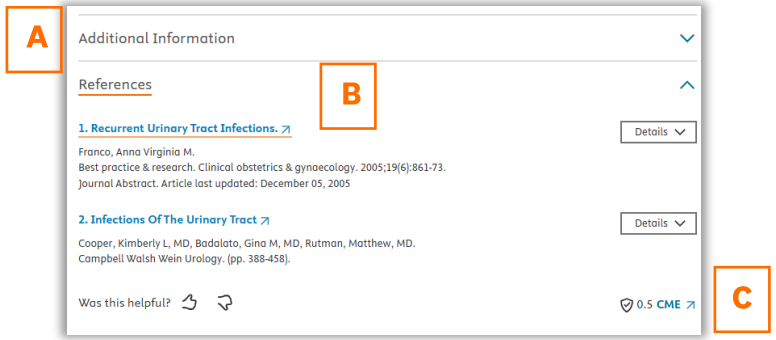


Figure 9. Additional information and references.

Point-of-Care mode

Use language toggle / Share conversation

Language toggle

Translation support for **French, German, Spanish, Italian, and Portuguese (Fig. 10)** for the primary response, *Additional Information* and *Follow-up* sections is included for ClinicalKey AI.

The language toggle will only display when a query has been submitted in the supported non-English languages.

While the system may support additional non-English translations, those languages have not been validated. The list of supported languages will grow over time.

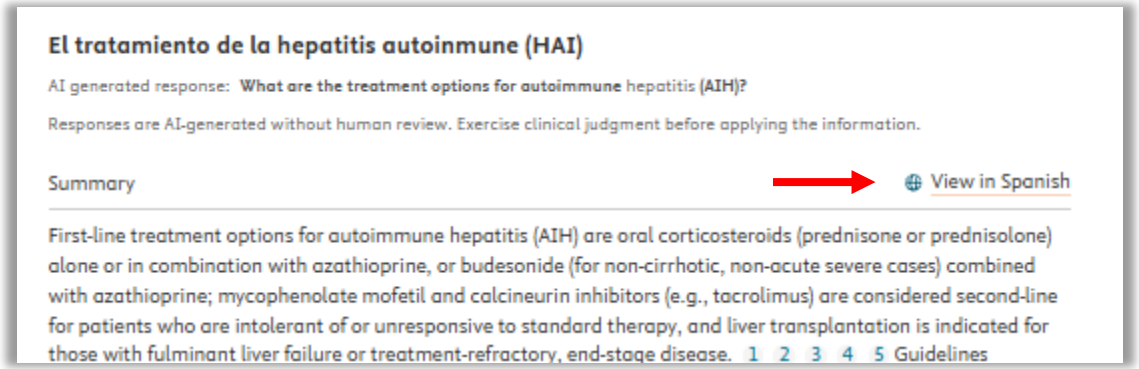


Figure 10. Clinical query in Spanish. *Arrow, View in Spanish* toggle.

Share conversation

Share your conversations with another medical professional by clicking the Share (*Share* icon) button above any question. A preview of the question will be displayed, along with a warning to not share protected health information **(Fig. 11).**

The recipient of the message will be required to log in or register for an account and accept the Elsevier terms and conditions to view the shared conversation.

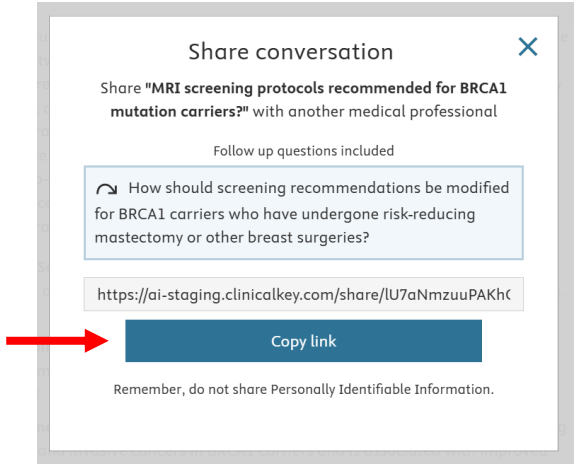


Figure 11. Share conversation. *Top arrow, Copy link.*

Point-of-Care mode

View references / Access ClinicalKey

References

1. Select *Details* **(Fig. 12, *right arrow*)** to display the content that was sourced for the answer.
2. Click the title of the reference **(Fig. 12, *left arrow*)** to link out to the source content.

Content is refreshed daily for ClinicalKey AI.

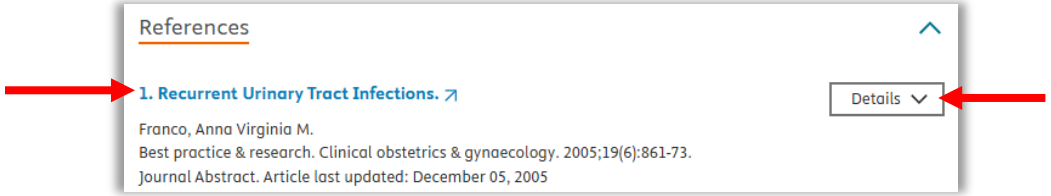


Figure 12. References. *Arrow, right, Details.* *Arrow, left,* title of reference links to sourced content.

Linking to ClinicalKey

Register or log in **(Fig. 13)** to use the ClinicalKey personalization features, such as:

- Saved content
- PDF downloads
- Presentations
- CME credits
- Remote access

For more information about creating a personal account and its benefits, please visit this guide.

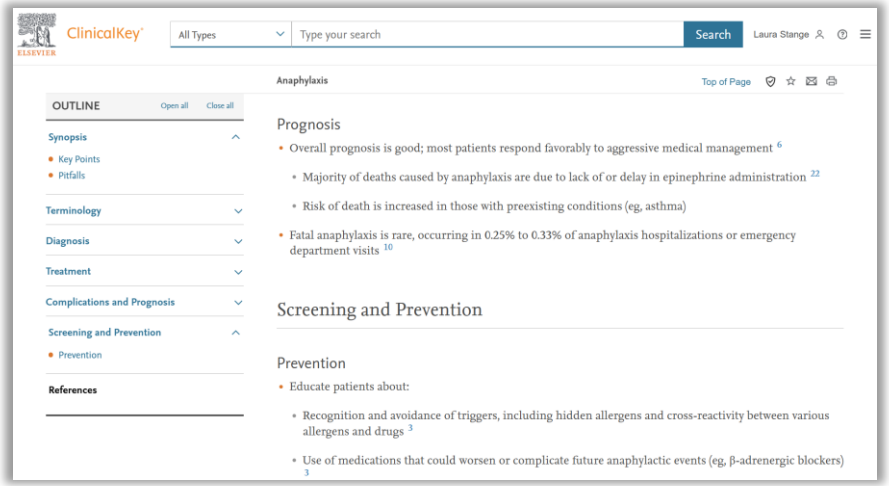


Figure 13. Source content on ClinicalKey.

Point-of-Care mode

Ask follow-up questions

1. Scroll below the AI-assisted response, once complete, to input a follow-up question **(Fig. 14A).**

OR

2. Select from the suggested list of follow-up questions **(Fig. 14B).**

Do not include PHI or personal data. Do not use as a calculator, scoring or staging tool, or for IV compatibility.*

* If your organization has executed a business associate agreement (BAA) with us that is in effect, this may not apply; ask your administrator if unsure.

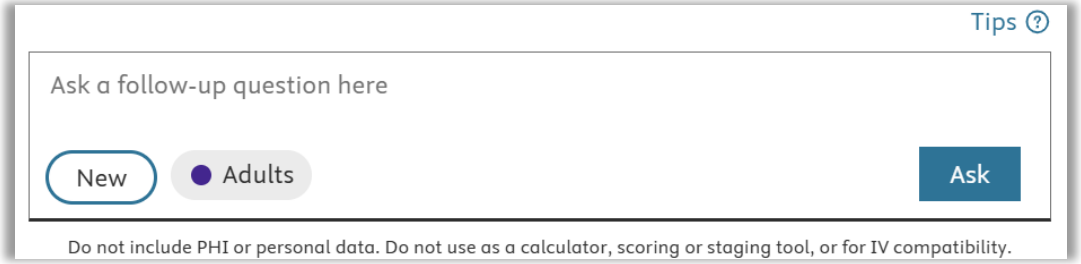


Figure 14A. Follow-up question field.

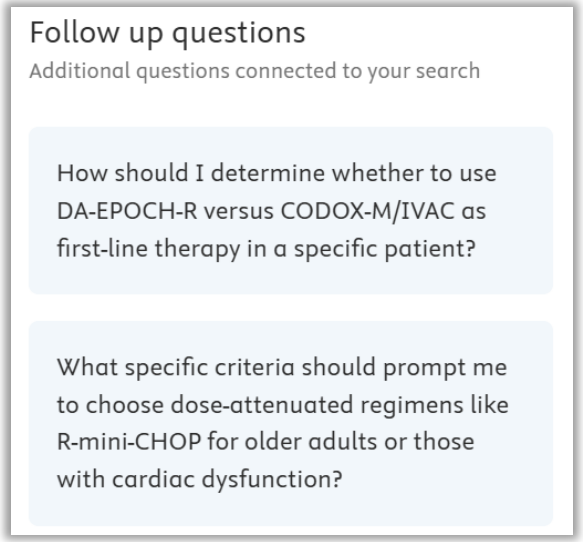


Figure 14B. Suggested list of follow-up questions.

Deep Research mode

Introduction / Guardrails

What is Deep Research?

- The Deep Research mode **(Fig. 15)** synthesizes evidence across trusted medical sources to help you investigate questions that require more depth than a standard search. The feature is designed to support research discovery, evidence synthesis, comparison, and identification of research gaps.
- It primarily uses Scopus, a publisher-neutral database that selects content based on peer review, academic quality, and publication ethics.

Guardrails

The Deep Research mode is designed to **reject** the following:*

- Patient- or case-specific decision making
- Differential diagnosis
- Diagnostic workup

* Guardrail activations are logged for evaluation and refinement.

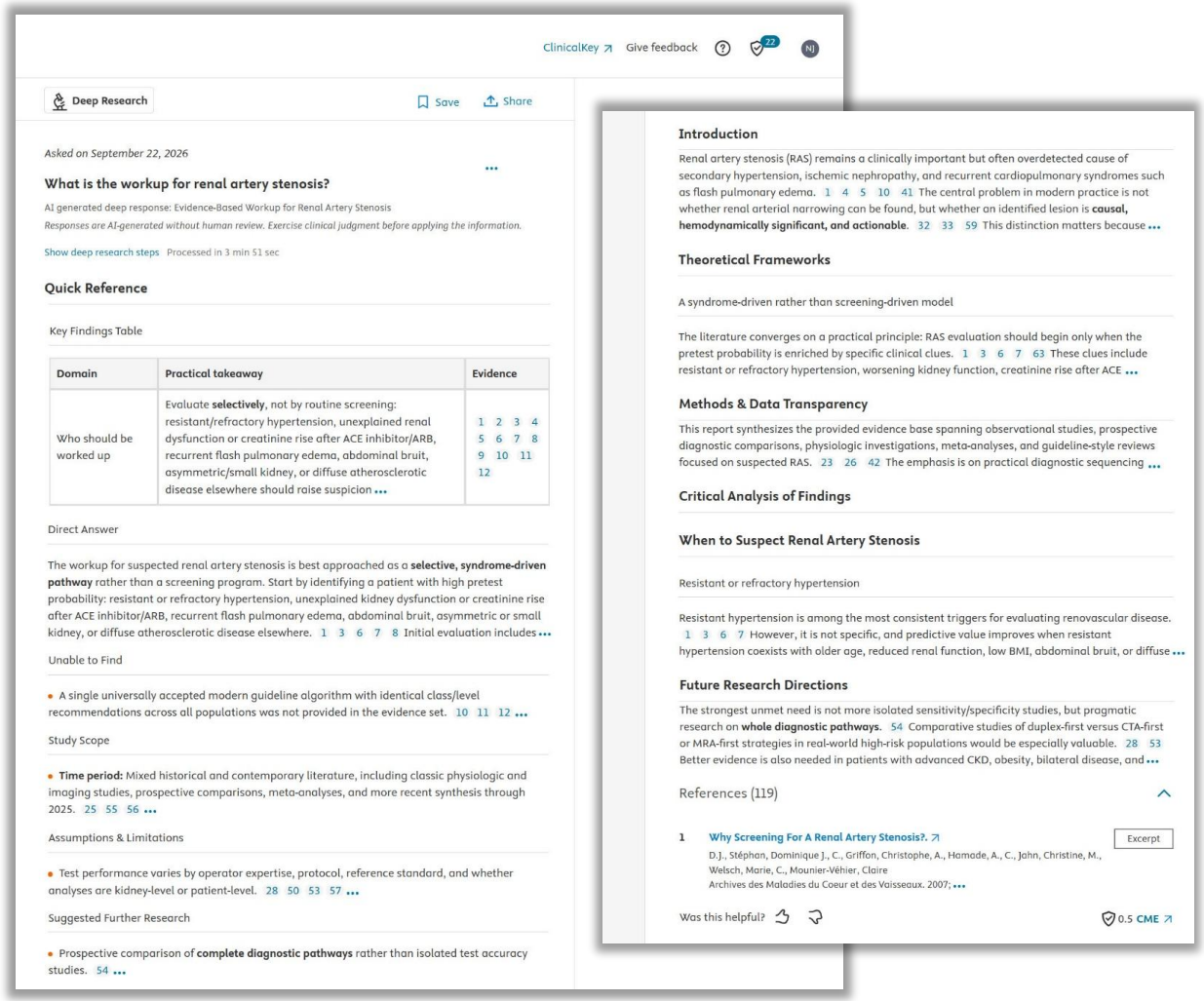


Figure 15. ClinicalKey AI query results: Deep Research mode.

Deep Research mode

Generate in-depth report

Choose the ***Deep Research*** mode for in-depth reports and analysis **(Fig. 16, *A*)**. (In contrast, *Point-of-Care* mode is for fast, evidence-based clinical decision making.)

- The process to produce the report could take up to about 3 minutes, as noted in the blue box above the Ask field **(Fig. 16, *B*)**.
- Search tips are accessible above the text field **(Fig. 16, *C*)**.
- Enter your clinical question into the text field using natural language **(Fig. 16, *D*)**. Instructions below the search field warn that you should not include protected health information (PHI) nor should you use ClinicalKey AI as a calculator, as a staging tool, or for IV compatibility **(Fig. 16, *E*)**.
- Query examples are provided **(Fig. 16, *F*)**. Tips are also included in the Get Started Guide.

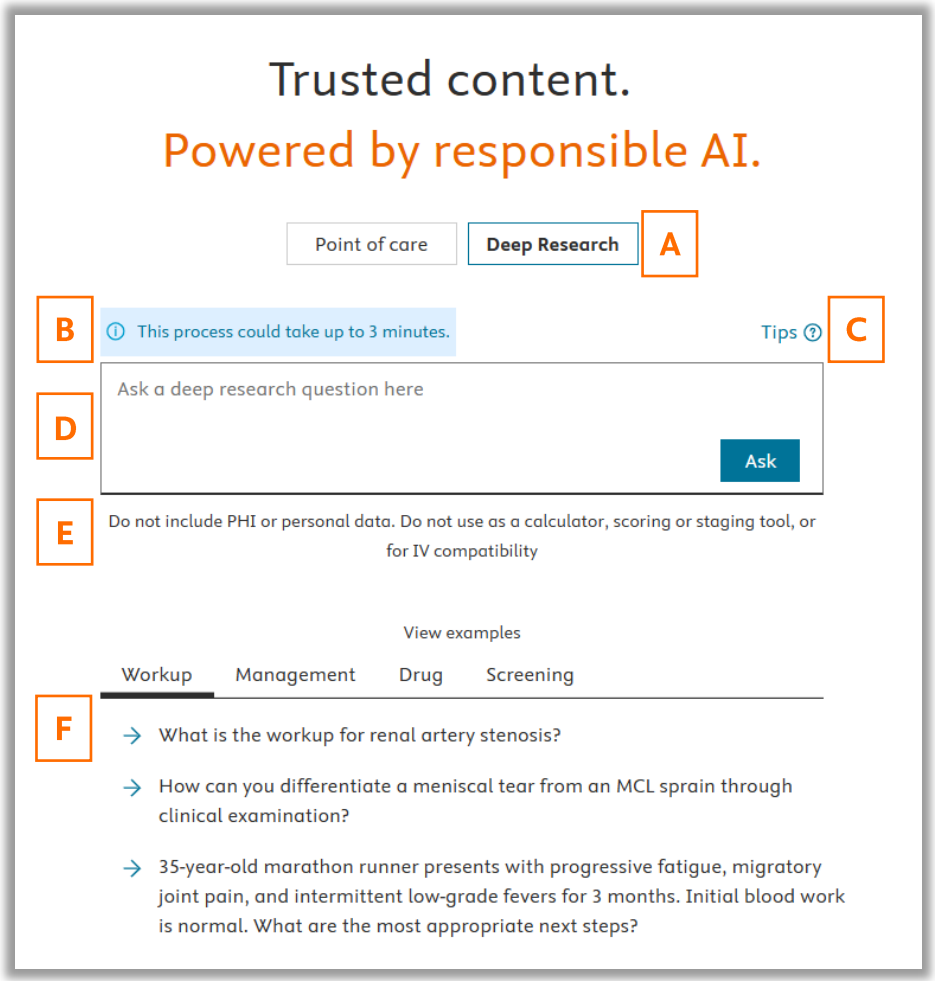


Figure 16. ClinicalKey AI home page: Deep Research mode. *A,* Mode buttons *(Deep Research* has been selected); *B,* time estimate; *C, Tips; D, Ask* field; *E,* instructions; *F,* query examples.

Deep Research mode

Review report and analysis

1. ClinicalKey AI will re-write the query with applied spelling checks and expand any acronyms before the response is generated on-screen **(Fig. 17, *A*)**.

2. Most Deep Research content is provided in the query language when supported. Although the system may support languages other than English, they have not been validated.

3. Review the AI-generated report and analysis **(Fig. 17, *B*)**.

If ClinicalKey AI cannot generate a response, based on current literature sources, an *Insufficient Evidence* message will display.

4. Choose to *Save* for future use or *Share** the query with a colleague **(Fig. 17, *C*)**.

   * If sharing is configured for your institution; see additional details here.

5. Consult *References* for evidence-based sourcing and publication details, and apply your own subject-matter judgment before relying on the output.

   The reference excerpt will display in the right panel **(Fig. 18, *arrow*)** when you click the in-text citation number or the *Excerpt* button in the References list.

6. Redeem your earned CME credits by clicking the link in the upper-right or lower-right corner of the page.

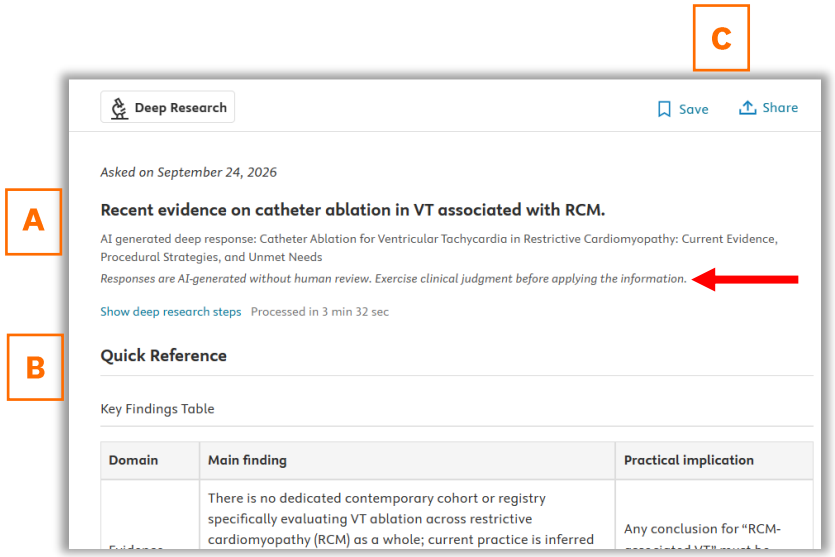


Figure 17. ClinicalKey AI response.
Arrow, AI-generated response disclaimer.

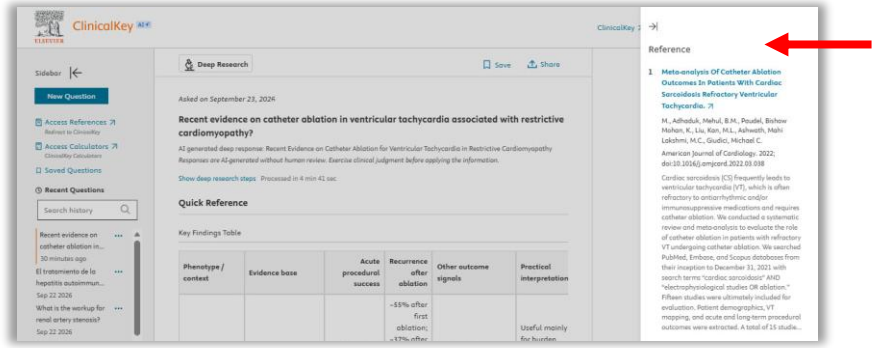


Figure 18. Reference excerpt displays in right panel *(arrow)*.

Download the app

1. Scan the QR codes on the right with your mobile device's camera to open the Store **(Figs. 19, 20).**
2. Click to download and install. (This is a free-of-charge app but it requires you, as an individual or your institution, to be subscribed to ClinicalKey AI.)

After completing these steps, you will be able to start using the ClinicalKey AI mobile app.



Figure 19. Google Play Store QR code.



Figure 20. Apple App Store QR code.

Mobile app

Explore the app

Prior to using the app:

On the login page, enter the email address associated with your user profile.

Once logged in (Fig. 21):

A. Input clinical query using natural language in the "Ask a question here" box.

B. Change the population focus.

C. Launch *My CME* to claim and redeem credits.

D. Click your account in the top right, then *Application Settings* to navigate to:
   - *How It Works* (including information on content curated for point of care use)
   - *Contact Us* and *Help*
   - *Registered User Agreement*

E. Click on the ☰ icon in the top left to access references, calculators, saved and recent questions and more **(Fig. 22).**

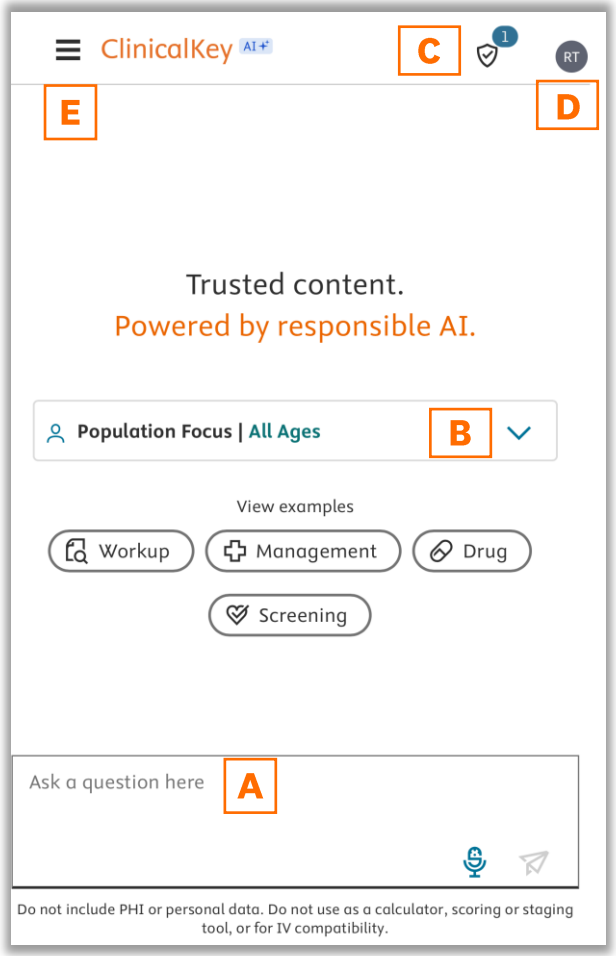


Figure 21. CK AI Mobile App home page.

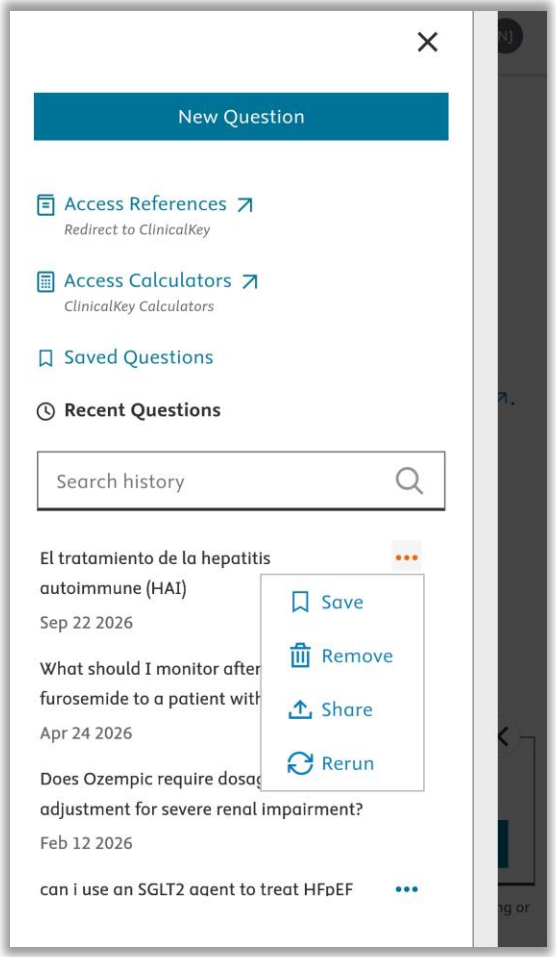


Figure 22. CK AI Mobile App menu.

Mobile app

Enable talk-to-text feature

Use the talk-to-text mobile device feature to perform even quicker searches.

1. Tap the microphone icon inside the question box **(Fig. 23)**.
2. Speak your question, then tap the Send icon to display response **(Fig. 23)**.
3. Talk-to-text is actively recording when you see the dotted line at the bottom of the input field. The pause button temporarily stops the recording **(Fig. 24)**.

Consult the Get Started Guide for search tips and additional guidance.

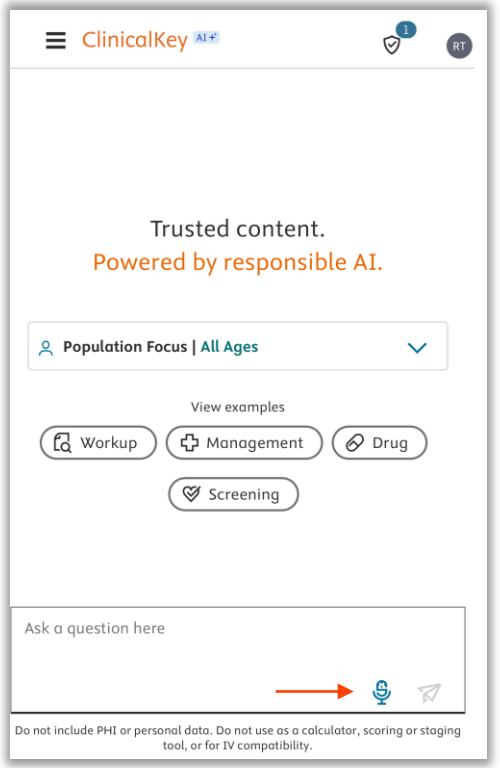


Figure 23. Home page on Android phone. *Arrow, microphone icon enabling talk-to-text.*

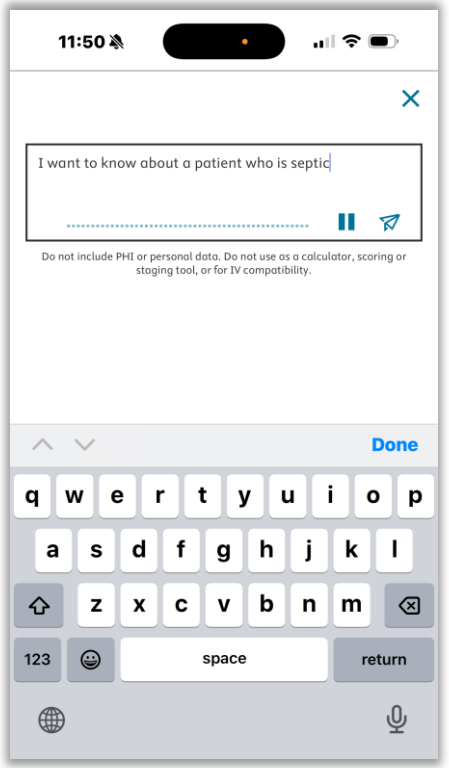


Figure 24. Live transcription in progress.

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